

Christiaan Verhoef

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Canonical

Software Alliance Ecosystem Manager

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Dear Canonical Hiring Team,

I have been running Ubuntu infrastructure for over a decade. Not as a user, but as the person who provisions it, maintains it, and brings others onto it. My current AI research environment at Windesheim runs on Linux with Docker, monitoring through Nagios, and CI/CD pipelines I maintain myself. I say this because ecosystem roles in software often go to people who know the platform from the partner side only. I know it from the inside.

The work your Software Alliance role describes is work I recognise. At Tonomy Foundation, which I co-founded, we built an open source protocol for decentralised identity and had to create the partner ecosystem around it from nothing. We engaged the W3C DID working group, wrote the whitepaper that anchored the commercial narrative, and onboarded the partners that gave the protocol credibility. The whole motion: capture requirements, find the gaps, build the enablement materials, activate the network, drive adoption. All of it, with no marketing budget and a global audience.

On content and enablement specifically: at WDS Global I inherited a backlog of ten thousand unresolved customer support tickets. I designed a tutorial video series for HTC smartphone users and proposed it as the scalable answer. HTC adopted it globally as their standard customer education format. It outlasted my time there by years. The Blockchain Minor I designed at Hogeschool Inholland has the same property: four years later, both programs still run without me. Good partner content keeps working after the person who built it has moved on.

Open Food Chain added the community activation layer. I built and moderated a technical Discord from zero, simplified the investor onboarding documentation, and shaped the narrative that helped attract new investment. The growth was designed, not organic.

Canonical's mission is a genuine draw. I have built on open source infrastructure throughout my career because I find it more honest to advocate for than systems I cannot inspect. The Ubuntu platform is one I believe in from direct use, not from reading about it.

Travel up to 25% of the time is fine. I have worked in Norway, Azerbaijan, Jordan, Oman, Slovakia, Germany, and the UK. Fully remote suits the way I work well.

With kind regards,

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